GDG Algiers ER Task 02: Finding the Right Contact

Oct 21, 2026 · @ch

I would send one targeted message to the person who owns each type of request, ask them to redirect me if they are not the right owner, and never contact all six people at once.

What I would do

I match each need to the role that controls it, with a backup if there is no reply.

What we need	First contact	Backup	Why this role
Financial sponsorship	Marketing	Communication, or the Founder in a small company	Marketing usually holds sponsorship and event budgets; in a small firm the founder decides directly.
Speakers	Community Manager	Founder or Communication	Community managers run developer talks and know which engineers speak in public.
Internships and recruitment	HR	Community Manager	HR owns hiring and approves internship offers; the community manager can introduce us.
Media promotion	Communication	Marketing or Community Manager	They control press, social channels and the content calendar.
Venue and logistics	Communication or Marketing (events)	Founder in a small company	They coordinate company spaces and equipment; a founder can approve a venue loan.

Sales is not a first contact for any of these. I would only approach Sales as a referral, for example when our attendees are potential customers for their product.

Each message asks for one thing only and ends with a line asking who the right person is if the reader is not. If there is no reply after four days, I follow up by LinkedIn with the backup contact.

Why I would make this decision

A request reaches a decision faster when it lands with the person who owns that budget or process. Messaging everyone at once looks like spam, creates mixed answers and can leave two people each assuming the other will reply. One clear ask per message is easier

to approve, which matches the ER guideline of understanding what we need first.

What solution or alternative I would propose

If the right owner cannot be found, I start with the Community Manager or Communication, since both deal with outside organizations and can route the request. I also look for a warm link first: a GDG member, an alumnus or a past partner who works there. In a small company I go to the Founder directly.

What I would do differently in the future

I would keep a shared contact map for every company: name, role, the need that person owns, date contacted and status. I would ask "who decides this?" on every first call and record the answer, so the next person on the team does not start from zero.